

Ansible Lookup Plugins – Cheat Sheet

Plugin | What It Does | Practical Usage

file | Reads a file from controller | Load banners, configs, certs

env | Reads environment variables | CI/CD-driven deployments

pipe | Runs local shell commands | Git branch, timestamps, hostname

url | Fetches HTTP/HTTPS data | API calls, config services

template | Renders Jinja2 template | Dynamic config generation

password | Generates idempotent secrets | DB passwords, tokens

first_found | Selects first existing file | Env-aware configs

fileglob | Matches multiple files | Bulk copy, batch processing

ini | Reads INI-style configs | Legacy app configuration